

LIS 815: Indexing and Abstracting

Objective Examination

Time Allowed: 1 Hour 30 Minutes

Instructions

1. This paper contains ONE HUNDRED (100) objective questions.
 2. Answer ALL questions.
 3. Each question has four options, A to D. Only ONE option is correct.
 4. Circle or shade the letter of the correct option on your answer sheet.
 5. Each question carries one (1) mark.
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1. Subject indexing is best defined as:
 - A. The physical binding and shelving of documents
 - B. The process of representing a document's subject content with terms for retrieval
 - C. The process of printing a book's table of contents
 - D. A method of cataloguing authors alphabetically
 2. According to Lancaster (2003), subject indexing involves:
 - A. Assigning a call number to a document
 - B. Translating a document into another language
 - C. Binding related documents together
 - D. Determining subject content and assigning terms that adequately represent it for retrieval
 3. Subject analysis takes place:
 - A. Before index terms are assigned, as the indexer identifies the main topic and concepts
 - B. After index terms have been assigned
 - C. Only when a document is being digitised
 - D. Only in post-coordinate systems
 4. Which of the following is NOT one of the stated objectives of subject indexing?
 - A. Accurate subject representation
 - B. Maximising the number of pages in a document
 - C. Consistent access points
 - D. Reduction of ambiguity
 5. The guiding principle of indexing that requires the same concept always be represented by the same term is:
 - A. Consistency
 - B. Specificity
 - C. Selectivity
 - D. Objectivity
 6. Indexing in which the indexer selects terms from a controlled vocabulary, rather than copying words from the document, is called:
 - A. Derived indexing
 - B. Assigned indexing
 - C. Automatic indexing
 - D. Free-text indexing
 7. Early retrieval systems relied mainly on access by:
 - A. Subject and keyword
 - B. Abstract and citation
 - C. Publisher and price

D. Author and title

8. An index is best described as:

- A.** A systematically arranged guide to a document's contents, with terms and locators
- B.** A chronological list of a book's chapters
- C.** A summary of a document written by its author
- D.** A list of a document's illustrations only

9. Which scholar defined indexing as analysing content, selecting significant concepts, and arranging them systematically to facilitate retrieval?

- A.** Cyril Cleverdon
- B.** S. R. Ranganathan
- C.** Mulvany (2005)
- D.** Derek Austin

10. In an index entry, the page or section reference is called the:

- A.** Heading
- B.** Locator
- C.** Subheading
- D.** Cross-reference

11. A 'See also' reference in an index is used to:

- A.** Correct a spelling error
- B.** Direct a reader to a related but distinct topic worth consulting
- C.** Direct a reader from a non-preferred term to the preferred term
- D.** Indicate that an entry has been deleted

12. Which of these is TRUE of a table of contents but NOT of an index?

- A.** It is arranged alphabetically
- B.** It lists subjects, names and concepts
- C.** It usually appears at the end of a book
- D.** It appears at the beginning of a book and follows the book's own order

13. An index arranged by the names of persons discussed in a work, whether or not they are authors, is a:

- A.** Citation index
- B.** Geographical index
- C.** Chronological index
- D.** Name index

14. Which of the following is the FIRST stage in the process of preparing a book index?

- A.** Reading the book
- B.** Assigning locators
- C.** Alphabetical arrangement
- D.** Proofreading

15. In indexing, semantics refers to:

- A.** The order in which concepts are combined
- B.** The study of meaning and how concepts and terms relate to one another
- C.** The physical layout of an index page
- D.** The choice of font used in an index

16. A Broader Term (BT) represents:

- A.** A more general concept than the term it is attached to
- B.** A more specific concept than the term it is attached to
- C.** A synonym of the term it is attached to
- D.** An unrelated concept

17. 'Libraries' is the Broader Term for 'University Libraries'; therefore 'University Libraries' is the:

- A. Related Term for Libraries
- B. Narrower Term for Libraries
- C. Preferred Term for Libraries
- D. Non-preferred Term for Libraries

18. A Related Term (RT) connects two concepts that are:

- A. Identical in meaning
- B. In a strict broader/narrower relationship
- C. Always spelled the same way
- D. Meaningfully associated but neither synonymous nor hierarchical

19. Syntax in indexing is concerned with:

- A. The meaning of individual words
- B. The colour scheme of a printed index
- C. The number of entries in a thesaurus
- D. How concepts are combined or ordered within an index expression

20. Role operators are especially important in which indexing system?

- A. KWIC
- B. Uniterm
- C. PRECIS
- D. Chain indexing

21. Changing the citation order of concepts in an indexing expression can:

- A. Never affect meaning
- B. Change the emphasis or even the meaning of the expression
- C. Only affect how the index looks visually
- D. Automatically improve recall

22. A controlled vocabulary is best described as:

- A. Any list of words found in a dictionary
- B. A list of banned words in an index
- C. A set of terms unique to one single document
- D. An organised set of approved terms used consistently for indexing and retrieval

23. What distinguishes a retrieval thesaurus from an ordinary dictionary?

- A. A thesaurus never contains definitions
- B. A dictionary is always larger
- C. A thesaurus is structured by defined relationships such as BT, NT and RT
- D. A thesaurus only contains one-word terms

24. In 'CARS USE AUTOMOBILES', which term is the preferred term?

- A. Automobiles
- B. Cars
- C. Both are preferred
- D. Neither is preferred

25. Which of these is NOT a common source of candidate terms for a thesaurus?

- A. Document titles and abstracts
- B. Author-supplied keywords
- C. The indexer's personal diary
- D. Existing published vocabularies

26. Medical Subject Headings is more commonly known by the abbreviation:

- A. LCSH
- B. ERIC

- C. AGROVOC
- D. MeSH

27. The correct direction for a hierarchical relationship is:
- A. LIBRARIES BT ACADEMIC LIBRARIES
 - B. ACADEMIC LIBRARIES BT LIBRARIES
 - C. LIBRARIES RT ACADEMIC LIBRARIES only
 - D. ACADEMIC LIBRARIES UF LIBRARIES
28. Which is the correct FIRST step in constructing a thesaurus?
- A. Test the thesaurus against real tasks
 - B. Define the subject field the thesaurus will cover
 - C. Publish the finished thesaurus
 - D. Assign USE/UF references
29. A scope note is used to:
- A. Clarify how a term should be interpreted within a vocabulary
 - B. List every document indexed under a term
 - C. Show the page number of a term's first use
 - D. Translate a term into another language
30. 'AUTOMOBILES — UF: Cars' means:
- A. Automobiles is Used For Cars
 - B. Cars is the preferred term
 - C. Cars is a non-preferred term that leads to the preferred term Automobiles
 - D. Automobiles and Cars are unrelated
31. An alphabetical thesaurus display is most convenient when a user:
- A. Wants to browse a whole subject area without knowing specific terms
 - B. Already knows the specific term and wants to inspect its relationships
 - C. Wants to see terms grouped by concept only
 - D. Wants to avoid using any terms at all
32. A classified thesaurus display supports:
- A. Searching by exact page number
 - B. Removing all cross-references
 - C. Combining post-coordinate Boolean searches only
 - D. Browsing across related conceptual areas
33. Which of the following is a typical thesaurus maintenance task?
- A. Adding new terms and updating cross-references as terminology changes
 - B. Deleting the entire vocabulary annually
 - C. Preventing any revision once published
 - D. Converting all terms into acronyms
34. Thesaurus-management software mainly supports:
- A. Replacing the intellectual judgement of the indexer entirely
 - B. Entry, relationship checking, version control and publication
 - C. Physical printing of books only
 - D. Determining a document's price
35. USE and UF are best described as:
- A. Two unrelated indexing systems
 - B. Formulas for calculating recall
 - C. A pair of reciprocal references linking preferred and non-preferred terms
 - D. Types of book indexes

- 36.** In pre-coordinate indexing, concepts are combined:
- A. By the searcher at the time of retrieval
 - B. By the indexer at the time of indexing, before any search takes place
 - C. Automatically by AI only
 - D. Only when using Boolean operators
- 37.** Chain indexing is most closely associated with:
- A. Derek Austin
 - B. S. R. Ranganathan
 - C. Cyril Cleverdon
 - D. Calvin Mooers
- 38.** Chain indexing derives subject entries from:
- A. The alphabetical order of authors
 - B. A random sample of index terms
 - C. The hierarchical chain of concepts in a classification scheme
 - D. The publisher's marketing description
- 39.** Cyclic (cycled) indexing works by:
- A. Varying the position of terms in a compound subject to create multiple access points
 - B. Deleting terms that repeat too often
 - C. Translating index terms into several languages
 - D. Removing all cross-references from an entry
- 40.** A key limitation of pre-coordinate indexing is that:
- A. The indexer must anticipate combinations that may not match what users actually search for
 - B. It cannot be used with classification schemes
 - C. It never provides controlled representation
 - D. It requires no intellectual effort at all
- 41.** Which of the following is an ADVANTAGE of pre-coordinate systems?
- A. They require no trained indexers
 - B. Explicit relationships between concepts are preserved
 - C. They always produce more results than post-coordinate systems
 - D. They eliminate the need for subject analysis
- 42.** For the subject 'Use of AI in University Libraries in Nigeria', a cycled entry could be:
- A. AI use only, with no other terms
 - B. A single entry with no reordering
 - C. Nigeria — University Libraries — Artificial Intelligence
 - D. An entry sorted by document length
- 43.** SLIC stands for:
- A. Systematic Listing of Index Cards
 - B. Structured Language Indexing Catalogue
 - C. Selective Listing in Combination
 - D. Sequential Listing of Index Concepts
- 44.** PRECIS stands for:
- A. Pre-Coordinate Retrieval and Classification Index System
 - B. Primary Concept Index Search
 - C. Permuted Retrieval and Citation Index System
 - D. Preserved Context Index System
- 45.** PRECIS was developed by:
- A. S. R. Ranganathan
 - B. Cyril Cleverdon

- C. Derek Austin
 - D. Calvin Mooers
46. PRECIS was originally developed for use by:
- A. The Library of Congress
 - B. UNESCO
 - C. The National Library of Nigeria
 - D. The British National Bibliography
47. Role operators in PRECIS are used to:
- A. Indicate the function each concept plays within a subject statement
 - B. Determine the price of a document
 - C. Replace the need for subject analysis
 - D. Convert an index into a table of contents
48. Which of the following is the correct FIRST step in building a PRECIS-style string?
- A. Apply the prescribed role operators
 - B. Understand the subject of the document as a whole
 - C. Generate the finished index string
 - D. Identify the role each concept plays
49. The list 'students; libraries; databases; use' is problematic because it:
- A. Contains too few words
 - B. Uses only Related Terms
 - C. Does not show the relationship between who is using what
 - D. Cannot be alphabetised
50. In post-coordinate indexing, concepts are combined:
- A. By the indexer, before the document is added to the collection
 - B. Only by using a printed thesaurus
 - C. Never — post-coordinate systems do not permit combination
 - D. By the searcher or system, at the point of retrieval
51. Uniterm indexing illustrates the basic principle of:
- A. Post-coordinate indexing
 - B. Pre-coordinate indexing
 - C. Chain indexing
 - D. PRECIS
52. Free-text searching looks for words in fields such as titles or abstracts:
- A. Without relying entirely on a controlled vocabulary
 - B. Using only a controlled vocabulary
 - C. Only after translation into a second language
 - D. Only in printed indexes
53. A limitation of free-text searching is that it can suffer from:
- A. Excessive vocabulary control
 - B. Too many cross-references
 - C. An inability to use any keyboard characters
 - D. Synonyms not being matched and ambiguous or misspelled words
54. Historically, optical coincidence systems used physical cards to:
- A. Print entire books
 - B. Identify documents sharing a chosen set of terms
 - C. Replace the need for indexing altogether
 - D. Store abstracts only

- 55.** Compared to pre-coordinate indexing, post-coordinate indexing generally offers:
- A.** Less flexibility but more control
 - B.** No difference at all
 - C.** Fewer possible search combinations
 - D.** More flexible combination of terms at search time, with more responsibility on the searcher
- 56.** A document assigned the separate terms 'Artificial Intelligence', 'University Libraries' and 'Reference Services' without any pre-set combined expression illustrates:
- A.** Pre-coordinate indexing
 - B.** Chain indexing
 - C.** Post-coordinate indexing
 - D.** PRECIS role operators
- 57.** A search strategy is best described as:
- A.** A random combination of any words
 - B.** A planned approach to translating an information need into searchable terms and combinations
 - C.** A method used only in book indexing
 - D.** A fixed list that never changes during a search
- 58.** The Boolean operator that NARROWS a search by requiring both concepts to be present is:
- A.** OR
 - B.** NOT
 - C.** USE
 - D.** AND
- 59.** 'CARS OR AUTOMOBILES' will retrieve documents containing:
- A.** Only 'Cars'
 - B.** Only 'Automobiles'
 - C.** Either term
 - D.** Neither term
- 60.** Derived indexing obtains its index terms from:
- A.** A controlled vocabulary chosen independently of the document
 - B.** A randomly generated word list
 - C.** Features of the document itself, such as its title
 - D.** The indexer's personal opinion
- 61.** KWIC stands for:
- A.** Keyword Indexed by Chapter
 - B.** Key Weighted Index Catalogue
 - C.** Keyword Isolated from Content
 - D.** Keyword in Context
- 62.** In a KWOC display, the keyword is shown:
- A.** Separately from the title, typically as a heading above the citation
 - B.** Embedded within the surrounding title text
 - C.** Only in a footnote
 - D.** In a different language from the rest of the entry
- 63.** A key advantage of derived indexing is that it is:
- A.** Always more accurate than assigned indexing
 - B.** Immune to problems with synonyms
 - C.** Only usable in pre-coordinate systems
 - D.** Fast, economical, and well suited to automation
- 64.** A document is considered 'relevant' when it:
- A.** Genuinely satisfies the user's information need

- B.** Contains the exact search word, regardless of content
 - C.** Was published within the last year
 - D.** Has the shortest title in the collection
- 65.** Exhaustivity refers to:
 - A.** How precisely a single term represents a concept
 - B.** The extent to which important concepts in a document are represented by index terms
 - C.** The total number of documents in a collection
 - D.** The number of synonyms a thesaurus contains
- 66.** Specificity refers to:
 - A.** The number of index terms assigned to a document
 - B.** How precisely an indexing term represents the actual subject of a document
 - C.** The physical size of a document
 - D.** How quickly a document can be retrieved
- 67.** For a document specifically about university libraries, which term is MORE specific?
 - A.** Libraries
 - B.** Information centres
 - C.** University Libraries
 - D.** Institutions
- 68.** The Cranfield research tradition is most closely associated with:
 - A.** Derek Austin
 - B.** S. R. Ranganathan
 - C.** Cyril Cleverdon
 - D.** Mulvany
- 69.** The Cranfield experiments were significant because they:
 - A.** Banned the use of controlled vocabularies
 - B.** Eliminated the need for precision and recall
 - C.** Established systematic, evidence-based evaluation using test collections and relevance judgements
 - D.** Focused only on book indexing
- 70.** Retrieving far too many irrelevant documents in a search is known as:
 - A.** Over-retrieval
 - B.** Under-retrieval
 - C.** Fallout
 - D.** Exhaustivity
- 71.** Precision is calculated as:
 - A.** $\text{Relevant Retrieved} \div \text{Total Relevant}$
 - B.** $\text{Non-Relevant Retrieved} \div \text{Total Non-Relevant}$
 - C.** $\text{Relevant Retrieved} \div \text{Total Retrieved}$
 - D.** $\text{Total Retrieved} \div \text{Total Relevant}$
- 72.** Recall is calculated as:
 - A.** $\text{Relevant Retrieved} \div \text{Total Relevant}$
 - B.** $\text{Relevant Retrieved} \div \text{Total Retrieved}$
 - C.** $\text{Total Non-Relevant} \div \text{Total Retrieved}$
 - D.** $\text{Total Retrieved} \div \text{Total Documents}$
- 73.** Fallout is calculated as:
 - A.** $\text{TP} \div (\text{TP} + \text{FN})$
 - B.** $\text{TP} \div (\text{TP} + \text{FP})$
 - C.** $\text{TN} \div (\text{TN} + \text{FP})$
 - D.** $\text{FP} \div (\text{FP} + \text{TN})$

- 74.** If a search retrieves 20 documents, 15 of which are relevant, out of 100 relevant documents in the collection, the precision is:
- A.** 15%
 - B.** 20%
 - C.** 100%
 - D.** 75%
- 75.** Using the same figures as the previous question (15 relevant retrieved out of 100 total relevant), the recall is:
- A.** 75%
 - B.** 20%
 - C.** 85%
 - D.** 15%
- 76.** A broad search strategy tends to:
- A.** Increase precision but always reduce recall to zero
 - B.** Have no effect on either measure
 - C.** Increase recall but often reduce precision
 - D.** Only work in pre-coordinate systems
- 77.** To improve precision, a searcher should generally:
- A.** Use broader terms and the OR operator
 - B.** Remove all search terms
 - C.** Search only by publication date
 - D.** Use more specific terms and combine concepts with AND
- 78.** An abstract is best defined as:
- A.** A full reproduction of a document's text
 - B.** A list of a document's references only
 - C.** A concise representation of a document's content
 - D.** The table of contents of a document
- 79.** An abstract that tells the reader what a document covers, without reporting detailed findings, is called:
- A.** An informative abstract
 - B.** A critical abstract
 - C.** An indicative abstract
 - D.** A structured abstract
- 80.** An abstract that reports the purpose, method, findings and conclusion of a study is called:
- A.** An informative abstract
 - B.** An indicative abstract
 - C.** A slant abstract
 - D.** An author's abstract
- 81.** An abstract that also evaluates the strengths, weaknesses or significance of a document is called:
- A.** A critical abstract
 - B.** An indicative abstract
 - C.** A structured abstract only
 - D.** A derived abstract
- 82.** An abstract emphasising the aspects of a document most relevant to a specific audience is called:
- A.** An informative abstract
 - B.** A slant abstract
 - C.** An author's abstract
 - D.** A critical abstract

- 83.** A structured abstract typically organises its content under headings such as:
- A.** Preface, Foreword, Index, Appendix
 - B.** Title, Author, Publisher, Price
 - C.** Background, Objective, Method, Results, Conclusion
 - D.** Chapter, Section, Page, Line
- 84.** Which of the following should NEVER appear in a well-written abstract?
- A.** Unsupported claims or the personal opinions of the abstractor
 - B.** The purpose of the study
 - C.** The main findings
 - D.** The conclusion reached
- 85.** Current Awareness Services (CAS) exist to:
- A.** Replace the need for abstracts
 - B.** Keep users informed about newly available information in their subject area
 - C.** Archive documents permanently without access
 - D.** Translate documents automatically
- 86.** Selective Dissemination of Information (SDI) distributes material according to:
- A.** Alphabetical order of author surnames only
 - B.** A fixed schedule unrelated to user interests
 - C.** The size of the document
 - D.** Each user's individual interests or profile
- 87.** Which of the following is a major indexing and abstracting service?
- A.** Microsoft Word
 - B.** Adobe Photoshop
 - C.** WhatsApp
 - D.** Scopus
- 88.** Extractive summarisation works by:
- A.** Generating entirely new wording not found in the source
 - B.** Deleting the abstract altogether
 - C.** Selecting important words, phrases or sentences directly from the source
 - D.** Translating the document into another language
- 89.** Abstractive summarisation attempts to:
- A.** Represent the source's meaning using newly generated wording
 - B.** Copy the source document exactly
 - C.** Remove all findings from a study
 - D.** Avoid any computational methods
- 90.** AI-generated abstractive summaries should always be:
- A.** Published without review
 - B.** Checked against the source document, since details may be omitted or distorted
 - C.** Used only for fictional works
 - D.** Rejected in every case
- 91.** In the complete indexing-and-abstracting workflow, indexing mainly provides:
- A.** Structured access points that make a document findable
 - B.** The final full-text reading experience
 - C.** The document's price
 - D.** A replacement for abstracting
- 92.** Automatic indexing uses:
- A.** Computer algorithms to identify and assign terms with little or no manual intervention
 - B.** Only handwritten index cards

- C. Exclusively post-coordinate Boolean logic
 - D. A printed thesaurus alone, with no software involved
- 93. Which of the following is a recognised computer-assisted indexing software package?
 - A. Photoshop
 - B. AutoCAD
 - C. CINDEX
 - D. Excel Solver
- 94. A hyperlinked index differs from a traditional printed index in that it:
 - A. Links each entry directly to the relevant section of the document
 - B. Uses page numbers exclusively
 - C. Cannot contain cross-references
 - D. Must always be printed on paper
- 95. A dynamic index is distinctive because it:
 - A. Never changes once created
 - B. Updates automatically whenever the underlying document is revised
 - C. Can only be used in printed books
 - D. Requires re-typing the entire book to update
- 96. Named-entity recognition, as used in AI-assisted indexing, helps to:
 - A. Recognise the names of people, organisations and places within a document
 - B. Print the final index automatically without any checking
 - C. Replace the need for locators
 - D. Convert a table of contents into an abstract
- 97. A key limitation of AI in indexing is that it often struggles to:
 - A. Count the number of words in a document
 - B. Process large collections quickly
 - C. Identify frequently occurring words
 - D. Judge which concepts are truly significant and resolve ambiguous meanings
- 98. In the 'Washington' example used to illustrate the continuing role of human indexers, the challenge is that the word could refer to:
 - A. Only one possible meaning
 - B. George Washington, Washington D.C., or Washington State
 - C. A type of thesaurus relationship
 - D. A Boolean operator
- 99. Which pairing correctly matches a system with its originator?
 - A. PRECIS — S. R. Ranganathan
 - B. Chain indexing — Cyril Cleverdon
 - C. Cranfield tests — Derek Austin
 - D. PRECIS — Derek Austin
- 100. Which of the following best summarises the overall relationship between indexing and abstracting?
 - A. They are unrelated activities performed by different professions with no shared purpose
 - B. Abstracting always precedes subject analysis
 - C. Indexing provides structured access points, while abstracting provides a concise representation of content, together supporting discovery and retrieval
 - D. Indexing has been fully replaced by automatic abstracting

Answer Key

Each cell shows the question number followed by the correct option.

1. B	2. D	3. A	4. B	5. A	6. B	7. D	8. A	9. C	10. B
11. B	12. D	13. D	14. A	15. B	16. A	17. B	18. D	19. D	20. C
21. B	22. D	23. C	24. A	25. C	26. D	27. B	28. B	29. A	30. C
31. B	32. D	33. A	34. B	35. C	36. B	37. B	38. C	39. A	40. A
41. B	42. C	43. C	44. D	45. C	46. D	47. A	48. B	49. C	50. D
51. A	52. A	53. D	54. B	55. D	56. C	57. B	58. D	59. C	60. C
61. D	62. A	63. D	64. A	65. B	66. B	67. C	68. C	69. C	70. A
71. C	72. A	73. D	74. D	75. D	76. C	77. D	78. C	79. C	80. A
81. A	82. B	83. C	84. A	85. B	86. D	87. D	88. C	89. A	90. B
91. A	92. A	93. C	94. A	95. B	96. A	97. D	98. B	99. D	100. C